



Reading Group: Against Military AI

Edition 2, Session 5: The Myth of
apolitical Science

Purpose of this reading group

- Open and respectful discussion about the use of AI for military purposes
- Topic is challenging
- Open to critiques of governments, companies and other institutions
- Objective: learn and discuss together
- We trust you to commit towards making this discussion respectful, inclusive and accountable

Accountability

Accountability means being responsible for yourself, your intentions, words and actions. It means entering a space with good intentions, but understanding that aligning your intent with action is the true test of commitment

Invitations

- Honour yourself: breaks, water
- Honour each other: listen & share generously. Empathy
- Practise sharing the mic
- Learning mindset. Curiosity

House rules

- Personal attacks of any kind or discrimination (anti-semitism, islamophobia, etc.) will not be tolerated
- Remote participants are required to have their cameras on
- No video / audio recordings are allowed

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- Concerns about political activism
- Political discussions *repeatedly brought by a specific group of students* make mila an unsafe environment
- Mila is a place for research not political discussions

Is mila apolitical ?

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- Climate Change
- Fairness
- Safety
- Bias in AI
- Energy
- “AI4Humanity”
- ResponsibleAI
- ...

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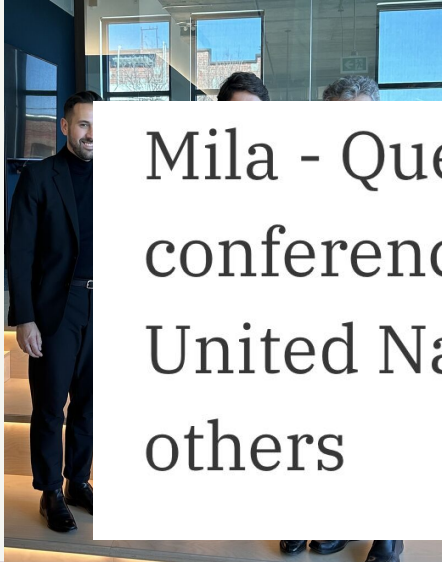
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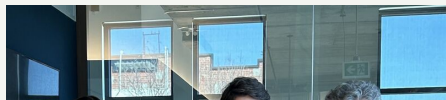
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Mila - Quebec AI Institute holds an international conference on AI and Human Rights with the United Nations, the OECD, UNESCO and many others

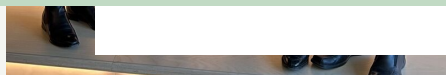
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AI Governance, Public Policy and Safety

Ensuring the seamless integration of artificial intelligence (AI) worldwide.



Is mila apolitical ?



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AI Helps Ukraine Charity Conference: A look back on the in-person event at Mila

December 8, 2022



Is mila apolitical ?



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Indigenous Pathfinders in AI

Delivered in partnership with [Indspire](#), Indigenous Pathfinders in AI is a career pathway program designed to inspire Indigenous talent to learn, develop and lead the evolution of artificial intelligence (AI), shaping a future marked by their contributions.



Is it only mila?

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Yeah, well North America has campus riots now in multiple places that can't seem to figure out how to keep campuses safe, while European universities seem to mostly focus on study & research... It is what it is... But at least UdeM is protected by Synchro being so time consuming nobody has any energy left to riot 🤪

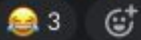


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 **Ezekiel Williams** 🦊 May 2nd at 5:11 PM

worth mentioning that the encampment at McGill (and afaik the others in Canada) are not riots but are actually really beautiful, self-organized, environments. I've been a few times to the McGill one this week and it's good vibes and entirely legal (the police actually issued a statement in response to McGill saying that they couldn't remove people because nobody was breaking the law lol)

12 🍀

NEW

👍 🗨️ 🦊 🍀 📌 🔄 ⋮

If Mila is not 'apolitical,' why do some people want to portray it as such?

*If Mila / Science / Universities are not
'apolitical,' why do some people want to
portray it as such?*

HISTORY OF SCIENCE

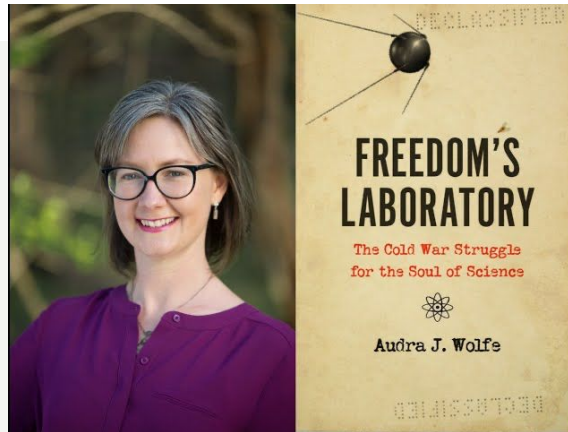
The myth of apolitical science

Denouncing state-controlled research, U.S. investigators advanced the American agenda during the Cold War

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(The cold war)

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 - Soviet approach to science was fundamentally antithetical (Gov involvement)
 - Receiving funding from american gov is not of the same nature

Chapter 2: efforts to mobilize science as a weapon

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 - sharing the advantages of the American scientific way
 - observing trends among foreign scientists as a form of intelligence collection
- The science is for building the weapon systems that underwrite “hard power.”

Epilogue:

- Who wins, and who loses, when scientists claim a unique ability to operate free from politics?
- The instinct to say that scientific truth cares not for the whims of political parties is understandable. But is it true?

